

Moving Earth

Earth's crust is divided up into large pieces called tectonic plates. These plates move around on the molten rock under them. Where the edges of these moving plates meet, the Earth's crust is unstable, and earthquakes and volcanic eruptions occur. Mountains may also form there.

KEY

All Earth's tectonic plates have names. The colour of the line along their edges tells you what type of boundary they have.

- **Convergent**
- **Divergent**
- **Transform**

Plate boundaries

These are where the edges of tectonic plates meet. There are three main types – convergent, divergent, and transform boundaries. They differ in how the plates involved meet.

Convergent boundary

Here, two plates move towards each other. They may push together, forming mountains. But, if one plate gets pushed under the other, a volcano can form.

